TNNLU B.Com. LL.B. (Hons.) — Semester I Syllabus

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How to use this

This is a reference syllabus for the six Semester I courses of TNNLU's B.Com. LL.B. (Hons.). TNNLU's own unit-wise course outlines are given to students by faculty each semester and are not published online; the "Course Catalogue" link on tnnlu.ac.in opens the 2025 Admissions Brochure, which lists course names only.

The units below follow standard Bar Council of India topics and comparable Tamil Nadu law-university syllabi. Expect each course to have 4–5 units and a research project. When Kaavya receives the official course outline for a paper, compare it with the matching section here and mark what differs.

#	Course	Type
1	Business English I	Language
2	Sociology: A Critical Introduction	Liberal discipline
3	Financial Accounting & Practical Auditing	Liberal discipline (commerce)
4	Business Organisation & Management	Liberal discipline (commerce)
5	Legal Methods	Core law
6	Law of Torts	Core law

1. Business English I

The course builds correct, precise English for law and business: grammar, legal vocabulary, reading set texts, and formal writing.

Unit	Topics
I. Language and law	Why precision matters in law; history and growth of English vocabulary; Latin and French legal terms in English; plain-English drafting

Unit	Topics
II. Grammar and usage	Parts of speech; sentence patterns (SV, SVO, SVC, SVOC); clauses; tense and concord; active and passive voice; reported speech; common errors
III. Vocabulary	Prefixes and suffixes; synonyms and antonyms; one-word substitutes; idioms; commonly confused words (affect/effect, principal/principle)
IV. Reading and comprehension	Prose pieces on law and liberty, such as Glanville Williams on methods of study, Bacon's "Of Truth", Mill's *On Liberty* (Ch. 1), the court scene in *The Merchant of Venice*; written comprehension
V. Business and formal writing	Précis writing; formal letters, e-mails, notices and memos; reports; minutes of meetings

Key books

- R.P. Bhatnagar, *Law and Language* (ed. N.R. Madhava Menon)
- Glanville Williams, *Learning the Law*
- J.C. Nesfield, *English Grammar, Composition and Usage*
- Rajendra Pal & J.S. Korlahalli, *Essentials of Business Communication*
- Elizabeth A. Martin, *Oxford Dictionary of Law* (keep at hand)

Practice tip: the campus language lab (Lanquill software) covers Units II–III and works on her own device.

2. Sociology: A Critical Introduction

The course explains how society is organised and changes, and links each idea to law. TNNLU's title signals a critical approach: question why institutions exist and whom they serve.

Unit	Topics
I. Fundamentals	Sociology as a science; scope and branches; methods; links with law, economics, political science and history

Unit	Topics
II. Basic concepts	Society, community, association; social structure and function; status and role; norms and values; culture and socialisation; social groups and processes
III. Thinkers	Auguste Comte, Herbert Spencer, Émile Durkheim, Max Weber, Karl Marx, Talcott Parsons
IV. Social institutions	Family, kinship and marriage; religion; education; economy and work; power and the state
V. Inequality and stratification	Caste, class and gender in India; social mobility
VI. Social control and change	Law as social control; custom and public opinion; theories and factors of social change; law as a tool of change

Key books

- C.N. Shankar Rao, *Sociology: Principles of Sociology with an Introduction to Social Thought* (easiest first text)
- M. Haralambos & R.M. Heald, *Sociology: Themes and Perspectives*
- M.N. Srinivas, *Social Change in Modern India*
- Kingsley Davis, *Human Society*
- Roger Cotterrell, *The Sociology of Law: An Introduction* (for the law link)

3. Financial Accounting & Practical Auditing

The course covers recording business transactions up to final accounts, then how an auditor checks them. It has the most numerical practice in Semester I, so it needs regular problem-solving rather than reading alone.

Unit	Topics
I. Basics of accounting	Meaning, objectives and users of accounting; book-keeping vs accounting; accounting concepts and conventions; accounting standards (Ind AS) in brief; the accounting equation

Unit	Topics
II. Journal and ledger	Double-entry system; golden rules (personal, real, nominal accounts); journal entries including compound entries; subsidiary books (cash book, purchase and sales books); posting to the ledger and balancing
III. Trial balance and adjustments	Trial balance; errors and their rectification; bank reconciliation statement; depreciation (straight-line and written-down value methods)
IV. Final accounts	Trading account; profit and loss account; balance sheet; adjustments (closing stock, outstanding and prepaid items, provisions) for a sole trader
V. Practical auditing	Meaning, objectives and types of audit; internal control and internal check; vouching; verification and valuation of assets and liabilities; auditor's report; auditor's appointment, rights and duties under the Companies Act, 2013 (overview)

Key books

- T.S. Grewal, *Introduction to Accountancy* (gentlest start if she did not take commerce in Class XII)
- R.L. Gupta & V.K. Gupta, *Principles and Practice of Accounting*
- S.N. Maheshwari & S.K. Maheshwari, *Financial Accounting*
- M.N. Arora, *Financial Accounting* (Taxmann)
- B.N. Tandon, *A Handbook of Practical Auditing*; or Dinkar Pagare, *Principles and Practice of Auditing*

Unit V is drawn from standard B.Com. auditing syllabi, because the comparable law-university syllabi checked did not publish auditing units.

4. Business Organisation & Management

The course covers how businesses are formed and how managers run them. It is the commerce base for later Company Law, Partnership and Contract courses.

Unit	Topics
I. Nature of business	Meaning, characteristics and objectives of business; industry, commerce and trade; business and its environment; social responsibility of business
II. Forms of business organisation	Sole proprietorship; partnership (including LLP); Hindu Undivided Family business; joint stock company (private, public, one-person); co-operatives; public sector enterprises; choosing a form
III. Nature of management	Concept and features; management vs administration; science, art or profession; levels of management; evolution of thought: F.W. Taylor's scientific management and Henri Fayol's 14 principles
IV. Planning, decision-making and organising	Planning process and types; management by objectives; decision-making process; organisation structure (line, line-and-staff, functional, matrix); authority, responsibility, delegation; centralisation and decentralisation; span of control
V. Staffing, directing and controlling	Recruitment, selection and training; motivation (Maslow, Herzberg, McGregor's Theory X and Y); leadership and communication; coordination; control process and techniques

Key books

- C.B. Gupta, *Business Organisation and Management* (Sultan Chand)
- Y.K. Bhushan, *Fundamentals of Business Organisation and Management*
- S.A. Sherlekar, *Modern Business Organisation and Management*
- L.M. Prasad, *Principles and Practice of Management*
- Koontz & Weihrich, *Essentials of Management*

5. Legal Methods

Legal Methods teaches how to think and work as a lawyer: what law is, where it comes from, and how to read statutes and cases. It is the most important Semester I paper, because every later law course uses these skills.

Unit	Topics
I. Concept of law	Meaning and functions of law; law, morality and justice; rule of law; classification of law (public/private, civil/criminal, substantive/procedural, national/international)
II. Sources of law	Custom; legislation and delegated legislation; precedent; the Constitution as the supreme source; equity, justice and good conscience; juristic writing
III. Legal systems and the courts	Common law and civil law families; Indian legal system; hierarchy of courts (Supreme Court, High Courts, subordinate courts, tribunals); Article 141 and binding precedent
IV. Reading a statute	Parts of an Act (title, preamble, sections, provisos, explanations, schedules); basic rules of interpretation: literal, golden and mischief rules; harmonious construction
V. Reading a case: precedent	Ratio decidendi and obiter dicta; distinguishing and overruling; per incuriam; dissenting opinions; writing a case brief (facts, issues, arguments, holding, reasoning)
VI. Legal research and writing	Primary and secondary sources; law reports and citations (SCC, AIR); online databases (SCC Online, Manupatra, Indian Kanoon); legal writing and citation style; plagiarism
VII. Moot court and advocacy	Purpose of moots; reading a moot problem; memorials; oral arguments and court etiquette

Key books

- Glanville Williams, *Learning the Law* (read first; short and friendly)
- N.R. Madhava Menon (ed.), *Clinical Legal Education*
- Tushar Kanti Saha, *Textbook on Legal Methods, Legal Systems and Research*
- M.P. Jain, *Outlines of Indian Legal and Constitutional History* (for the courts unit)
- G.P. Singh, *Principles of Statutory Interpretation* (reference only at this stage)

GNLU's equivalent course runs 55 sessions across these themes and is assessed by a moot (20 marks), mid-semester exam (30) and end-semester exam (50). TNNLU's weighting may differ.

6. Law of Torts

Torts are civil wrongs, such as negligence, nuisance or defamation, for which a court awards damages. Indian tort law is largely judge-made, so this course is learnt through cases more than statutes.

Unit	Topics	Leading cases
I. General principles	Definition and nature of a tort; tort vs crime, contract and breach of trust; *injuria sine damno* and *damnum sine injuria*; role of malice and intention	Ashby v White; Gloucester Grammar School case; Bhim Singh v State of J&K
II. General defences	Volenti non fit injuria; plaintiff the wrongdoer; inevitable accident; act of God; private defence; necessity; mistake; statutory authority	Padmavati v Dugganaika; Stanley v Powell; Nichols v Marsland
III. Capacity and vicarious liability	Who can sue and be sued; master's liability for servant; independent contractors; State liability and sovereign immunity	Lloyd v Grace, Smith & Co; Kasturi Lal v State of UP; State of Rajasthan v Vidyawati
IV. Negligence	Duty of care, breach, damage; res ipsa loquitur; contributory negligence; nervous shock; professional and medical negligence	Donoghue v Stevenson; Jacob Mathew v State of Punjab
V. Strict and absolute liability	Rule in Rylands v Fletcher and its exceptions; absolute liability in India	Rylands v Fletcher; M.C. Mehta v Union of India (Oleum gas leak)
VI. Nuisance and trespass	Public and private nuisance; trespass to land and goods; conversion	Ram Raj Singh v Babulal; Radhey Shyam v Gur Prasad
VII. Wrongs to the person and reputation	Assault, battery, false imprisonment, malicious prosecution; defamation (libel and slander) and its defences	Rudul Sah v State of Bihar; R. Rajagopal v State of TN

Unit	Topics	Leading cases
VIII. Remedies and remoteness	Damages (kinds); injunction; remoteness of damage; joint tortfeasors	Re Polemis; The Wagon Mound (No. 1)

Key books

- Ratanlal & Dhirajlal, *The Law of Torts* (standard Indian text)
- R.K. Bangia, *Law of Torts* (simple language; good for first reading)
- P.S.A. Pillai, *Law of Torts*
- Winfield & Jolowicz, *Tort* (reference)
- Salmond & Heuston, *Law of Torts* (reference)

Some NLUs also teach the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 and motor accident claims under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 in this course; check the TNNLU outline.

Study tips and sources

- Start with Legal Methods and Torts; their skills (case briefing, finding the ratio) carry into every later law paper.
- Do accounting problems weekly; reading alone does not build speed.
- Keep a one-page case card per leading case: facts, issue, decision, principle.
- Replace this reference syllabus with TNNLU's official course outline as each one arrives.

Sources

- TNNLU – Undergraduate Programmes (course list)
- TNNLU Admissions Brochure 2025 (current course structure)
- Tamil Nadu Dr. Ambedkar Law University – 5-year syllabus (Torts, Sociology, English units)
- Dr. M.G.R. University – B.Com. LL.B. (Hons.) syllabus (English, Management units)
- CUSAT – B.Com. LL.B. (Hons.) syllabus (Financial Accounting, Business Organisation units)
- GNLU – Legal Methods, Semester I (Legal Methods modules and assessment)